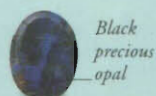


Gems

Precious stones



Drop-shaped morganite



Black precious opal



Sapphire



Brilliant cut diamond



Pendeloque emerald



Octagonal aquamarine



Cushion cut ruby



Morganite, which is coloured by manganese, is the pink form of beryl.



Opal is hardened silica gel. Precious opal is iridescent.



Sapphire is a precious form of corundum. It is usually blue.



Diamonds are made from carbon placed under extreme pressure.



Emerald is a green variety of beryl.



Aquamarines are a blue-green variety of beryl.



Ruby is the red, precious form of corundum.

Semi-precious stones



Smoky quartz crystals joined together in a twisted group.



Amazonstone is a blue-green type of microcline.

Crystallization progresses towards centre of cavity



Quartz crystals are built-up in layers.



Amethyst is a purple form of quartz.



Rose quartz is best used for carvings and making into beads.



Calcite is the main component of limestone and marble.

Chalcedony is a massive variety of quartz made from tiny fibres, or grains, of silicon dioxide.



Rose quartz is usually found in great lumps – single crystals are very rare.



Labradorite can be multi-coloured and has a sheen.



Rhodochrosite gets its colour from manganese.

Turquoise is usually intense blue or green.



Turquoise is sought after for its amazing colours.

Some people believe crystals have healing properties.



Rock crystal is an almost colourless form of quartz.



Lapis lazuli contains several different minerals.



Carnelian is a red variety of chalcedony.

Organic gems



Coral is the calcium carbonate skeleton of colony-living sea creatures. It is usually pink.

Coral carving



Polished amber bead



Amber is the fossilized resin, or sap, of trees. It is usually translucent.



Ivory relief

Ivory comes from the teeth and tusks of mammals. The best ivory comes from the African elephant.



Shell pill box



Mother-of-pearl lining of shells is prized for its iridescence.

Cut and polished jet



Jet containing fossils

Jet is a fine-grained black stone formed from very hard coal.



Pearls



Pearls are tiny pellets of calcium carbonate that form inside some shellfish.